

FREE RESOURCE · COACHING

GROW Model Quick Reference

The GROW model structures a coaching conversation into four stages — Goal, Reality, Options, Will — moving from what someone wants, to where they actually stand, to what they could do, to what they will commit to.

G
GOAL

R
REALITY

O
OPTIONS

W
WILL

G Goal

Opening the conversation, or whenever discussion has lost focus.

1. What would you like to achieve from this conversation?
2. What does success look like for you here?
3. By when do you want to achieve this?
4. How will you know you've got there?
5. What would make this conversation worthwhile today?
6. Is this goal within your control to influence?
7. How does this connect to what matters to you?
8. What's the real goal beneath the goal you named?
9. If you could only achieve one thing, what's that?
10. What would a good outcome look like in 6 months?

Common mistake: Skipping straight to solutions before the goal is actually clear.

R Reality

After the goal is named, before jumping to solutions.

1. What's happening right now, in specific terms?
2. What have you already tried?
3. What's working, and what isn't?
4. What's the impact of this, and on whom?
5. What's stopping you from being where you want?
6. On a scale of 1–10, how would you rate today?
7. What are you assuming that might not be true?
8. Who else is affected by this situation?
9. What haven't you told me that might matter?
10. What's different this time vs. last time?

Common mistake: Accepting the first explanation without probing for the full picture.

O Options

Once the reality is clear, before committing to a plan.

1. What options do you have here?
2. What else could you do?
3. What if resources weren't a constraint?
4. What's worked for you or others before?
5. What would you advise a friend to do here?
6. What's the boldest option on this list?
7. What haven't you considered yet?
8. Which option excites you most, and why?
9. What would happen if you did nothing?
10. Which option best fits both goal and reality?

Common mistake: Settling for the first option instead of generating several.

W Will / Way Forward

Closing the conversation with clear ownership.

1. Which option will you choose?
2. What's the very first step, and by when?
3. How committed are you to this, from 1–10?
4. What might get in the way, and how will you handle it?
5. What support do you need, and from whom?
6. How will you know you're on track?
7. What would make you abandon this plan?
8. Who will you tell about this commitment?
9. What will you do in the next 24 hours?
10. What should I follow up on next time?

Common mistake: Ending without a specific action, owner, or date attached.

TIPS FOR MANAGEMENT CONVERSATIONS

Let silence work. Don't rush to fill a pause — the best answers often come after it.

Stay in Reality longer. Resist jumping to Options before the situation is genuinely understood.

Ask, don't tell. If you're supplying the answer, you've left coaching and started managing.

Always land on Will. A GROW conversation without a committed next step hasn't finished.